

02477 BAYESIAN ML

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Cheat Sheets

DTU 02477 Bayesian Machine Learning — All 12 weeks

WEEK 1

Beta-Binomial & Bayesian Inference

MODEL

$$p(y \mid N, \theta) = \binom{N}{y} \theta^y (1 - \theta)^{N-y}$$

Prior: $\theta \sim \text{Beta}(a_0, b_0)$, with

$$p(\theta) = \frac{\theta^{a_0-1} (1 - \theta)^{b_0-1}}{B(a_0, b_0)}, \quad B(a, b) = \frac{\Gamma(a) \Gamma(b)}{\Gamma(a+b)}$$

CONJUGATE POSTERIOR UPDATE

$$p(\theta \mid y) = \text{Beta}(a_0 + y, b_0 + N - y)$$

BETA DISTRIBUTION PROPERTIES

Quantity	Formula
Mean	$\mu = \frac{a}{a+b}$
Mode	$\hat{\theta} = \frac{a-1}{a+b-2} \text{ (for } a, b > 1 \text{)}$
Variance	$\sigma^2 = \frac{ab}{(a+b)^2(a+b+1)}$

POSTERIOR MEAN AS SHRINKAGE

$$\mathbb{E}[\theta \mid y] = (1 - \lambda) \underbrace{\frac{a_0}{a_0 + b_0}}_{\text{prior mean}} + \lambda \underbrace{\frac{y}{N}}_{\hat{\theta}_{\text{MLE}}}, \quad \lambda =$$

As $N \rightarrow \infty$: $\lambda \rightarrow 1$ (data dominates). As $N \rightarrow 0$: $\lambda \rightarrow 0$ (prior dominates).

MLE & MODEL EVIDENCE

$$\hat{\theta}_{\text{MLE}} = \frac{y}{N}$$

$$p(y \mid N) = \binom{N}{y} \frac{B(a_0 + y, b_0 + N - y)}{B(a_0, b_0)}$$

CREDIBILITY INTERVAL & MONTE CARLO

The 95% credibility interval $[l, u]$ satisfies $P(l \leq \theta \leq u \mid y) = 0.95$.

Draw $\theta^{(s)} \sim p(\theta \mid y)$, then $\mathbb{E}[f(\theta) \mid y] \approx \frac{1}{S} \sum_{s=1}^S f(\theta^{(s)})$. Error = $O(1/\sqrt{S})$.

WEEK 2 Bayesian Logistic Regression

MODEL

$$p(y = 1 \mid x, \alpha, \beta) = \sigma(\alpha + \beta x), \quad \sigma(z) =$$

$$\text{Prior: } p(\alpha, \beta) \propto \exp\left(-\frac{\alpha^2}{2\sigma_\alpha^2} - \frac{\beta^2}{2\sigma_\beta^2}\right)$$

LOG JOINT

$$\log p(\alpha, \beta, \mathbf{y}) = \sum_n [y_n \log \sigma(f_n) + (1 - y_n) \log (1 - \sigma(f_n))]$$

GRID APPROXIMATION (3 STEPS)

1. Evaluate $\log p(\alpha_i, \beta_j, \mathbf{y})$ on a grid.
2. Subtract the maximum for stability, exponentiate: $\tilde{\pi}_{ij} = e^{\log p - \max}$.
3. Normalize: $\pi_{ij} = \tilde{\pi}_{ij} / \sum_{i,j} \tilde{\pi}_{ij}$.

POSTERIOR PREDICTIVE

$$p(y^* = 1 \mid x^*, \mathbf{y}) = \sum_{i,j} \sigma(\alpha_i + \beta_j x^*) \pi_{ij}$$

KEY PROPERTIES

- Grid approximation is exact up to discretization; cost is $O(G^D)$ — exponential in dimension D .
- Bayesian predictions are more conservative (wider) than MAP predictions.

WEEK 3 Bayesian Linear Regression

MODEL

$$p(\mathbf{y} \mid \mathbf{w}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{y} \mid \Phi \mathbf{w}, \beta^{-1} \mathbf{I}), \quad p(\mathbf{w}) = .$$

$\Phi \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times D}$ is the design matrix with rows $\phi(x_n)^T$.

CONJUGATE POSTERIOR

$$p(\mathbf{w} \mid \mathbf{y}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{w} \mid \mathbf{m}, \mathbf{S})$$

$$\mathbf{S} = (\alpha \mathbf{I} + \beta \Phi^T \Phi)^{-1}, \quad \mathbf{m} = \beta \mathbf{S} \Phi^T \mathbf{y}$$

POSTERIOR PREDICTIVE

For $f^* = \phi(x^*)^T \mathbf{w}$:

$$p(f^* \mid \mathbf{y}, x^*) = \mathcal{N}(f^* \mid \phi_*^T \mathbf{m}, \phi_*^T \mathbf{S} \phi_*)$$

$$p(y^* \mid \mathbf{y}, x^*) = \mathcal{N}(y^* \mid \phi_*^T \mathbf{m}, \phi_*^T \mathbf{S} \phi_* + \beta^{-1})$$

MLE (RIDGE)

$$\mathbf{w}_{\text{MLE}} = (\Phi^T \Phi)^{-1} \Phi^T \mathbf{y}$$

MARGINAL LIKELIHOOD (EVIDENCE)

$$p(\mathbf{y}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{y} \mid \mathbf{0}, \beta^{-1} \mathbf{I} + \alpha^{-1} \Phi \Phi^T)$$

Evidence approximation: maximize $\log p(\mathbf{y})$ wrt. α, β (empirical Bayes / MLII).
No cross-validation needed.

KEY PROPERTIES

- Posterior mean $\mathbf{m}$ is a shrinkage estimator (pulled toward zero by α).
- As $N \rightarrow \infty$, posterior concentrates around MLE.
- Posterior variance decreases as N grows.

WEEK 4 Laplace Approximation

CORE IDEA

Approximate the posterior $p(\mathbf{w} \mid \mathbf{y})$ with a Gaussian centered at the MAP estimate:

$$q(\mathbf{w}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{w} \mid \mathbf{w}_{\text{MAP}}, \mathbf{A}^{-1})$$

$$\mathbf{A} = -\nabla^2 \log p(\mathbf{w}, \mathbf{y}) \big|_{\mathbf{w}=\mathbf{w}_{\text{MAP}}}$$

($\mathbf{A}$ = negative Hessian of log joint = precision matrix.)

STEPS

1. Find $\mathbf{w}_{\text{MAP}} = \arg \max_{\mathbf{w}} \log p(\mathbf{w}, \mathbf{y})$ via gradient-based optimization.
2. Evaluate $\mathbf{A} = -\nabla^2 \log p(\mathbf{w}, \mathbf{y}) \big|_{\mathbf{w}_{\text{MAP}}}$.
3. Approximate posterior as $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{w}_{\text{MAP}}, \mathbf{A}^{-1})$.

LOGISTIC REGRESSION: GRADIENT & HESSIAN

Let $f_n = \mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{x}_n$, $S = \text{diag}(\sigma(f_n)(1 - \sigma(f_n)))$:

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{w}} \log p = -\mathbf{X}^T (\boldsymbol{\sigma} - \mathbf{y}) - \alpha \mathbf{w}$$

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{w}}^2 \log p = -\mathbf{X}^T S \mathbf{X} - \alpha \mathbf{I} \quad \Rightarrow \quad \mathbf{A} = \mathbf{X}$$

PREDICTIVE APPROXIMATIONS

Let $f^* = \mathbf{w}^T \phi_*$, so $f^* \sim \mathcal{N}(m^*, v^*)$ with $m^* = \mathbf{w}_{\text{MAP}}^T \phi_*$, $v^* = \phi_*^T \mathbf{A}^{-1} \phi_*$.

Method	Formula
Plug-in	$p(y^* = 1) \approx \sigma(m^*)$
Probit	$p(y^* = 1) \approx \sigma\left(\frac{m^*}{\sqrt{1 + \pi v^*/8}}\right)$
MC	$p(y^* = 1) \approx \frac{1}{S} \sum_s \sigma(f^{*(s)}),$ $f^{*(s)} \sim \mathcal{N}(m^*, v^*)$

GENERATIVE VS DISCRIMINATIVE

- **Generative:** models $p(y, x) = p(x | y)p(y)$; class-conditional + prior.
- **Discriminative:** models $p(y | x)$ directly; logistic regression, neural networks.

WEEK 5 Gaussian Processes

GP PRIOR

A GP is defined by a mean function $m(x)$ and kernel $k(x, x')$:

$$f \sim \mathcal{GP}(m(\cdot), k(\cdot, \cdot))$$

Typically $m(x) = 0$.

COMMON KERNELS

Squared Exponential (SE):

$$k_{\text{SE}}(x, x') = \sigma_f^2 \exp\left(-\frac{(x - x')^2}{2\ell^2}\right)$$

Matérn 3/2:

$$k_{\text{M32}}(r) = \sigma_f^2 \left(1 + \frac{\sqrt{3} r}{\ell} \right) \exp \left(-\frac{\sqrt{3} r}{\ell} \right)$$

Hyperparameters: length-scale ℓ (smoothness), signal variance σ_f^2 (amplitude), noise variance σ_n^2 .

GP REGRESSION POSTERIOR

Given $\mathbf{y} = f(\mathbf{X}) + \boldsymbol{\epsilon}$, $\boldsymbol{\epsilon} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \sigma_n^2 \mathbf{I})$, let $\mathbf{C} = K(\mathbf{X}, \mathbf{X}) + \sigma_n^2 \mathbf{I}$:

$$\boldsymbol{\mu}_{f^*} = K(\mathbf{X}^*, \mathbf{X}) \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{y}$$

$$\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{f^*} = K(\mathbf{X}^*, \mathbf{X}^*) - K(\mathbf{X}^*, \mathbf{X}) \mathbf{C}^{-1} K(\mathbf{X}, \mathbf{X}^*)$$

Predictive: $p(y^* | \mathbf{y}, x^*) = \mathcal{N}(y^* | \boldsymbol{\mu}_{f^*}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{f^*} + \sigma_n^2)$.

LOG MARGINAL LIKELIHOOD (MLII)

$$\log p(\mathbf{y}) = -\frac{1}{2} \mathbf{y}^T \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{y} - \frac{1}{2} \log |\mathbf{C}| - \frac{N}{2}$$

Cholesky: $\mathbf{L} = \text{chol}(\mathbf{C})$, so $\log |\mathbf{C}| = 2 \sum_i \log L_{ii}$.

Hyperparameter optimization: maximize $\log p(\mathbf{y})$ wrt. $\ell, \sigma_f^2, \sigma_n^2$ via gradient ascent.

KEY PROPERTIES

- Posterior mean = kernel-weighted interpolation.
- Posterior variance = 0 at training points (noise-free).
- Short ℓ : wiggly. Long ℓ : smooth.

WEEK 6 GP Classification

MODEL

$$p(y_n = 1 \mid f_n) = \sigma(f_n), \quad f \sim \mathcal{GP}(0, k(\cdot, \cdot))$$

The posterior $p(\mathbf{f} \mid \mathbf{y})$ is **non-Gaussian** — no conjugacy.

LAPLACE APPROXIMATION FOR LATENT GP

Find $\hat{\mathbf{f}} = \arg \max_{\mathbf{f}} \log p(\mathbf{f} \mid \mathbf{y})$ and approximate $q(\mathbf{f}) = \mathcal{N}(\hat{\mathbf{f}}, (K^{-1} + \Lambda)^{-1})$, where $\Lambda = \text{diag}(\lambda_n)$, $\lambda_n = \sigma(f_n)(1 - \sigma(f_n))$.

Gradient: $\mathbf{g} = \mathbf{y} - \boldsymbol{\sigma}(\mathbf{f}) - K^{-1}\mathbf{f}$

Newton update: $\mathbf{f}^{\text{new}} = \mathbf{f} + (K^{-1} + \Lambda)^{-1}\mathbf{g}$

Numerically stable covariance

(Woodbury): $\mathbf{S} = K - K\Lambda^{1/2}\mathbf{B}^{-1}\Lambda^{1/2}K$,
 $\mathbf{B} = \mathbf{I} + \Lambda^{1/2}K\Lambda^{1/2}$

PREDICTIVE DISTRIBUTION (3-STEP PIPELINE)

Step 1 — posterior mean:

$$\mu_{f^*} = k(x^*, \mathbf{X}) K^{-1} \hat{\mathbf{f}}$$

Step 2 — posterior variance:

$$\sigma_{f^*}^2 = k(x^*, x^*) - k(x^*, \mathbf{X}) (K + \Lambda^{-1})^{-1} k$$

Step 3 — probit approximation:

$$p(y^* = 1 \mid \mathbf{y}, x^*) \approx \sigma \left(\frac{\mu_{f^*}}{\sqrt{1 + \pi \sigma_{f^*}^2 / 8}} \right)$$

Or MC: $p(y^* = 1) \approx \frac{1}{S} \sum_s \sigma(f^{*(s)})$,
 $f^{*(s)} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_{f^*}, \sigma_{f^*}^2)$.

WEEK 7 Multi-class Classification

SOFTMAX MODEL

$$\mathbf{f}_n = W \phi(x_n) \in \mathbb{R}^C, \quad p(y_n = c \mid \mathbf{f}_n) = \text{softmax}(\mathbf{f}_n)_c$$

$$\text{Prior: } p(W) = \mathcal{N}(\text{vec}(W) \mid \mathbf{0}, \alpha^{-1} \mathbf{I})$$

LOG JOINT & LAPLACE APPROXIMATION

$$\log p(W, \mathbf{y}) = \sum_n \log \text{softmax}(\mathbf{f}_n)_{y_n} - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|W\|^2$$

$$\text{MAP: } W_{\text{MAP}} = \arg \max_W \log p(W, \mathbf{y})$$

$$\mathbf{A} = -\nabla^2 \log p(W, \mathbf{y})|_{W_{\text{MAP}}} \text{ (JAX Hessian)},$$

$$q(W) = \mathcal{N}(W_{\text{MAP}}, \mathbf{A}^{-1}).$$

MC POSTERIOR PREDICTIVE

Sample $W^{(s)} \sim q(W)$:

$$\pi^* \approx \frac{1}{S} \sum_{s=1}^S \text{softmax}(W^{(s)} \phi(x^*))$$

UNCERTAINTY DECOMPOSITION

$$H_{\text{total}} = - \sum_c \pi_c^* \log \pi_c^*$$

$$H_{\text{aleatoric}} = \frac{1}{S} \sum_s H \left[\text{Cat}(\text{softmax}(W^{(s)} \phi)$$

$$H_{\text{epistemic}} = H_{\text{total}} - H_{\text{aleatoric}} \geq 0$$

High $H_{\text{epistemic}} \rightarrow$ out-of-distribution. High $H_{\text{aleatoric}} \rightarrow$ inherently ambiguous.

BAYESIAN DECISION THEORY & ECE

Optimal action: $\hat{y}^* =$

$\arg \max_a \sum_c \pi_c^* U(c, a)$, where $U(c, a)$ is the utility of action a when true class is c .

$$\text{ECE} = \sum_b \frac{|B_b|}{N} |\text{acc}(B_b) - \text{conf}(B_b)|$$

WEEK 8 MCMC (Metropolis-Hastings)

METROPOLIS-HASTINGS ALGORITHM

Goal: draw $\theta^{(1)}, \dots, \theta^{(K)} \sim p(\theta \mid \mathbf{y}) \propto p_t(\theta)$.

1. Propose $\theta^* \sim q(\theta^* \mid \theta^{(k-1)})$ (e.g. random walk $\theta^* = \theta^{(k-1)} + \epsilon, \epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \eta^2 I)$).
2. Compute log acceptance ratio (symmetric proposal): $\log r_k = \log p_t(\theta^*) - \log p_t(\theta^{(k-1)})$
3. Set $\theta^{(k)} = \theta^*$ with probability $\min(1, e^{\log r_k})$, else $\theta^{(k)} = \theta^{(k-1)}$.

Asymmetric proposal: add $\log q(\theta^{(k-1)} \mid \theta^*)$

$$\theta^*) - \log q(\theta^* \mid \theta^{(k-1)}) \text{ to } \log r_k.$$

BAYESIAN POISSON REGRESSION WITH HYPERPRIOR

$$y_n \sim \text{Poisson}(\exp(\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{x}_n)), \quad p(\mathbf{w} \mid \kappa) =$$

$$\text{Log joint: } \sum_n [y_n(\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{x}_n) - e^{\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{x}_n}] - \frac{\|\mathbf{w}\|^2}{2\kappa^2} + \log p(\kappa)$$

IMPORTANCE SAMPLING

$$\mathbb{E}_p[f(\theta)] \approx \frac{\sum_i w^{(i)} f(\theta^{(i)})}{\sum_i w^{(i)}}, \quad w^{(i)} = \frac{p(\theta^{(i)})}{q(\theta^{(i)})}$$

ANCESTRAL SAMPLING

Draw from joint $p(\theta_1, \theta_2, \dots)$ in topological order: $\theta_1 \sim p(\theta_1)$, then $\theta_2 \sim p(\theta_2 \mid \theta_1)$, etc.

PRACTICAL NOTES

- **Burn-in:** discard early samples until chain mixes.
- **Step size η :** too large $\rightarrow$ high rejection; too small $\rightarrow$ slow mixing. Target $\sim 23\text{--}65\%$ acceptance.
- **Thinning:** keep every k -th sample to reduce autocorrelation.

WEEK 9 Hamiltonian Monte Carlo (HMC)

HAMILTONIAN SYSTEM

Introduce momentum $\nu \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I})$ and simulate dynamics to get distant proposals with high acceptance:

$$H(\theta, \nu) = E(\theta) + K(\nu), \quad E(\theta) = -\log p(\theta)$$

$$\text{Dynamics: } \dot{\theta} = \nu, \dot{\nu} = -\nabla_{\theta} E(\theta).$$

LEAPFROG INTEGRATOR (L STEPS, STEP SIZE H)

$$\nu_{j+1/2} = \nu_j - \frac{\eta}{2} \nabla_{\theta} E(\theta_j)$$

$$\theta_{j+1} = \theta_j + \eta \nu_{j+1/2}$$

$$\nu_{j+1} = \nu_{j+1/2} - \frac{\eta}{2} \nabla_{\theta} E(\theta_{j+1})$$

HMC ACCEPTANCE & SAMPLING

Accept (θ^*, ν^*) with probability:

$$a_k = \min\left(1, e^{-H(\theta^*, \nu^*) + H(\theta^{(k-1)}, \nu^{(k-1)})}\right)$$

Discard ν^* after; sample fresh $\nu \sim \mathcal{N}(0, I)$ each iteration.

CONVERGENCE DIAGNOSTICS

R-hat (run M chains of length S):

$$\hat{R}^2 = \frac{S-1}{S} + \frac{1}{S} \frac{B}{W}$$

B = between-chain variance, W = within-chain variance. Want $\hat{R} < 1.01$.

ESS:

$$S_{\text{eff}} = \frac{S}{1 + 2 \sum_{t=1}^{\infty} \hat{\rho}_t}$$

$\hat{\rho}_t$ = autocorrelation at lag t . Want $S_{\text{eff}} \geq 100$ per chain.

HETEROSCEDASTIC REGRESSION & HMC VS MH

Positivity of variance via softplus: $\sigma_n^2 = \text{softplus}(g(\mathbf{x}_n)) = \log(1 + e^{g(\mathbf{x}_n)})$

	MH	HMC
Proposals	random walk	gradient-guided
Acceptance	often low in high-D	near 1 with good tuning
Autocorrelation	high	low
Requires	$\log p$	$\log p + \text{gradient}$

WEEK 10 Variational Inference & CAVI

ELBO DECOMPOSITION

$$\log p(\mathbf{X}) = \underbrace{\mathcal{L}[q]}_{\text{ELBO}} + \text{KL}[q(\mathbf{Z}) \| p(\mathbf{Z} | \mathbf{X})] \geq$$

$$\mathcal{L}[q] = \mathbb{E}_q[\log p(\mathbf{X}, \mathbf{Z})] - \mathbb{E}_q[\log q(\mathbf{Z})] = \mathbb{E}$$

$$\text{KL}[q||p] = \mathbb{E}_q[\log q - \log p] \geq 0, \text{ equality iff } q = p.$$

MEAN-FIELD FAMILY & CAVI

$$q(\mathbf{Z}) = \prod_i q_i(Z_i)$$

Optimal factor (all others fixed):

$$\log q_j^*(Z_j) = \mathbb{E}_{-j}[\log p(\mathbf{X}, \mathbf{Z})] + \text{const}$$

Cycle through all factors until ELBO converges.

GAUSSIAN-GAMMA CAVI UPDATES

Model: $x_n \mid \mu, \tau \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \tau^{-1})$, prior: $\mu \mid \tau \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_0, (\lambda_0 \tau)^{-1})$, $\tau \sim \text{Gamma}(a_0, b_0)$.

$$q^*(\mu) = \mathcal{N}(\mu \mid m, v), \quad v = \frac{1}{\mathbb{E}[\tau](N + \lambda_0)}$$

$$q^*(\tau) = \text{Gamma}(\tau \mid a, b), \quad a = a_0 + \frac{N}{2}, \quad b = b_0 + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=1}^N (x_n - m)^2$$

BAYESIAN GMM KEY QUANTITIES

Responsibilities: $r_{nk} =$

$$\frac{\pi_k \mathcal{N}(x_n \mid \mu_k, \Lambda_k^{-1})}{\sum_j \pi_j \mathcal{N}(x_n \mid \mu_j, \Lambda_j^{-1})}$$

Effective counts: $N_k = \sum_n r_{nk}$

Posterior cluster mean (shrinkage):

$$m_k = (1 - \rho_k)m_0 + \rho_k \bar{x}_k, \quad \rho_k = \frac{N_k}{\beta_k}, \quad \beta_k = \frac{1}{\rho_k} + \frac{1}{\rho_0}$$

Prior: $\boldsymbol{\pi} \sim \text{Dir}(\alpha_0 \mathbf{1}), \mu_k \sim$

$$\mathcal{N}(m_0, \beta_0^{-1} \Lambda_k^{-1}), \Lambda_k \sim \text{Wishart}(W_0, \nu_0).$$

MEAN-FIELD UNDERESTIMATES VARIANCE

Optimal diagonal covariance: $\hat{V}_{ii} = 1/(V^{-1})_{ii} \leq V_{ii}$ whenever off-diagonal correlations are nonzero.

WEEK 11

Black-Box Variational Inference (BBVI)

ELBO & MEAN-FIELD GAUSSIAN ENTROPY

$$\mathcal{L}[q] = \underbrace{\mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{w})}[\log p(\mathbf{y}, \mathbf{w})]}_{\text{expected log joint}} + \underbrace{\mathcal{H}[q]}_{\text{entropy}}$$

Mean-field: $q(\mathbf{w}) = \prod_{i=1}^D \mathcal{N}(w_i \mid m_i, v_i)$,
variational parameters $\lambda = \{\mathbf{m}, \mathbf{v}\}$.

Analytical entropy: $\mathcal{H}[q] = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^D \log(2e\pi v_i)$

BBVI MONTE CARLO ELBO

$$\mathcal{L}[q] \approx \frac{1}{S} \sum_{s=1}^S \log p(\mathbf{y}, \mathbf{w}^{(s)}) + \mathcal{H}[q], \quad \mathbf{w}^{(s)}$$

REPARAMETRIZATION TRICK

Replace $\mathbf{w} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{m}, \text{diag}(\mathbf{v}))$ with:

$$\mathbf{w} = \mathbf{m} + \mathbf{s} \circ \boldsymbol{\epsilon}, \quad \boldsymbol{\epsilon} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \mathbf{I}), \quad s_i = \sqrt{v_i}$$

Moves λ -dependence outside the expectation, enabling gradient computation via autodiff:

$$\nabla_{\lambda} \mathbb{E}_{q_{\lambda}}[\log p(\mathbf{y}, \mathbf{w})] \approx \frac{1}{S} \sum_s \nabla_{\lambda} \log p(\mathbf{y}, \mathbf{w})$$

MINIBATCHING

For large N , approximate the log-likelihood term using a batch $\mathcal{M}$ of size $M \ll N$:

$$\mathbb{E}_q[\log p(\mathbf{y} \mid \mathbf{w})] \approx \frac{N}{M} \sum_{n \in \mathcal{M}} \mathbb{E}_q[\log p(y_n \mid \mathbf{w})]$$

Unbiased estimator when $\mathcal{M}$ is resampled each step.

ANALYTICAL ELBO FOR LINEAR GAUSSIAN

$$\mathcal{L} = \underbrace{\sum_n \log \mathcal{N}(y_n \mid \mathbf{m}^T \mathbf{x}_n, \sigma^2)}_{\text{expected log likelihood}} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \sum_{i,n}$$

LIKELIHOOD VARIANTS FOR BINARY CLASSIFICATION

Model	$p(y = 1 \mid f)$	Property
Sigmoid	$\sigma(f) = (1 + e^{-f})^{-1}$	Standard logistic
Probit	$\Phi(f)$ (Gaussian CDF)	Heavier tails
Robust	$(1 - \epsilon)\sigma(f) + \epsilon\sigma(-f)$	Tolerates mislabelled data

Optimize $\lambda = \{\mathbf{m}, \log \mathbf{v}\}$ (unconstrained, ensures $v_i > 0$) with **Adam**.

WEEK 12 Bayesian Deep Learning

HETEROSCEDASTIC NEURAL NETWORK

Two-output network: $f(\mathbf{x} \mid \mathbf{w}) \in \mathbb{R}^2$

$$\mu_{\mathbf{w}}(\mathbf{x}) = f_1(\mathbf{x} \mid \mathbf{w}), \quad \sigma_{\mathbf{w}}^2(\mathbf{x}) = e^{f_2(\mathbf{x} \mid \mathbf{w})} >$$

$$p(y_n \mid \mathbf{w}, \mathbf{x}_n) = \mathcal{N}(y_n \mid \mu_{\mathbf{w}}(\mathbf{x}_n), \sigma_{\mathbf{w}}^2(\mathbf{x}_n)),$$

MAP INFERENCE

$$\mathbf{w}_{\text{MAP}} = \arg \max_{\mathbf{w}} \left[\sum_n \log p(y_n \mid \mathbf{w}, \mathbf{x}_n) - \right]$$

Equivalent to L2-regularized MLE. Plugin predictive: $p(y^* \mid \mathbf{w}_{\text{MAP}}, \mathbf{x}^*)$.

Approximate posterior predictive: $p(y^* \mid \mathbf{y}, \mathbf{x}^*) \approx \frac{1}{S} \sum_{s=1}^S p(y^* \mid \mathbf{w}^{(s)}, \mathbf{x}^*), \mathbf{w}^{(s)} \sim q(\mathbf{w})$.

LAST-LAYER LAPLACE APPROXIMATION (LLLA)

Apply Laplace only to last-layer parameters

$$\mathbf{w}_L = \{\mathbf{W}_2, \mathbf{b}_2\}:$$

1. Compute $\mathbf{w}_{\text{MAP}}$ (full network via gradient descent).
2. Compute features: $\mathbf{z} = f_{1:L-1}(\mathbf{X} \mid \mathbf{w}_{1:L-1, \text{MAP}})$.

3. Hessian wrt. last layer only: $\mathbf{H} = \mathbf{H}_{\text{loglik}} + \alpha \mathbf{I}$
4. Posterior: $q(\mathbf{w}_L) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{w}_{L,\text{MAP}}, \mathbf{H}^{-1})$.
5. Predict: sample $\mathbf{w}_L^{(s)} \sim q$, compute $\mathbf{f}^{(s)} = \mathbf{W}_2^{(s)} \mathbf{z} + \mathbf{b}_2^{(s)}$.

Benefits: cheap (small Hessian), post-hoc (no retraining), captures uncertainty in final mapping.

DEEP ENSEMBLES (DE)

Train S networks from different initializations:

$$q_{\text{DE}}(\mathbf{w}) = \frac{1}{S} \sum_i \delta(\mathbf{w} - \mathbf{w}^{(i)})$$

Predictive (Gaussian mixture):

$$p(y^* | \mathbf{y}, \mathbf{x}^*) \approx \frac{1}{S} \sum_{i=1}^S \mathcal{N}(y^* | f_1^{(i)}(\mathbf{x}^*), e^{f_2^{(i)}})$$

MAP = degenerate ensemble with $S = 1$.

LOG PREDICTIVE DENSITY (LPD)

$$\text{LPD}(y^*) \approx \log \left[\frac{1}{S} \sum_s p(y^* | \mathbf{w}^{(s)}, \mathbf{x}^*) \right]$$

Average LPD = $\frac{1}{N_{\text{test}}} \sum_n \text{LPD}(y_n^*)$. Higher is better.

METHOD COMPARISON

Method	Uncertainty	Cost	OOD quality
MAP	None (point)	Low	Poor
LLLA	Epistemic	Low	Moderate

	(last layer)	(post-hoc)	
Deep Ensembles	Epistemic (functional)	High ($S \times$)	Good
Full Laplace	Epistemic (full)	Very high	Good
HMC	Full posterior	Highest	Best

UNCERTAINTY SOURCES

- **Aleatoric** ($\sigma_{\mathbf{w}}^2(\mathbf{x})$): data noise, irreducible, from heteroscedastic likelihood.
- **Epistemic** (spread of $q(\mathbf{w})$): model uncertainty, reducible with more data, from posterior.